



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Benedict Classical Catholic School
School Website: <https://www.stbenedictclassical.org/work/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Benedict Classical Catholic School in 47404 presents a clearly Catholic, liturgically oriented educational identity, anchored in a motto that foregrounds wisdom, faith, and virtue (Sapientia ~ Fides ~ Virtus) and in a stated aim to partner with parents to foster intellect and faith. Public materials consistently emphasize faith integration, liturgical life (Mass), Latin prayer practice, and Catholic affiliation (Archdiocese). These elements signal strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and robust Parents & Community engagement.

However, the publicly visible curriculum and pedagogy materials do not demonstrate the core liberal-arts content or classical teaching methods that define a fully classical program (e.g., grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books and Great Conversation; explicit Socratic or seminar-based pedagogy). In aggregate, the school's public materials align more with a religious, faith-formation orientation that incorporates classical flavor (Latin prayers, liturgical life, parental partnership) than with a comprehensive Classical School model as defined by the Six Essential Elements. As a result, the overall classification is NOT CLASSICAL, with Element 2 showing some classical alignment (formation-oriented aims) but Categories 3–5 lacking evidence of classical curriculum and pedagogy, and Element 6 showing meaningful parental partnership. The single strongest classical-aligned thread appears in the religious-community dimension, but it does not extend comprehensively across the full classical rubric.

Key takeaways by category:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (liturgical life, theology-inflected education, Catholic identity; Sapientia Fides Virtus; Mass; Archdiocese affiliation).
- School Purpose and Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (formation-oriented language around wisdom/virtue; faith-intellect integration; but lacking explicit classical telos statements beyond general formation).
- Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL (no explicit Great Books, liberal-arts Trinity, grammar/logic/rhetoric, or Great Books in public materials).
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL (no explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the public materials; liturgical/recitation cues exist but not a classical pedagogical framework).
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (no clear description of teachers as “living curriculum” or mentor-models in the public materials).
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (clear emphasis on partnering with parents; hospitality and family engagement are present as a core theme).

ABSTRACT

ly, the school sits in a landscape that blends Catholic formation with a classical sensibility but does not, based on visible public materials, meet the Six Essential Elements in a way that would classify it as CLASSICAL across the board.

Citations and evidence come from the school's own public materials and the classical education rubric and keyword lexicon used to judge alignment (see the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” rubric and keyword lexicon for indicators). Key items include the motto Sapientia ~ Fides ~ Virtus and the stated mission to partner with parents to foster intellect and faith, as well as explicit mentions of Latin prayers and Mass on the school's site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site presents a strong Catholic identity with the motto Sapientia ~ Fides ~ Virtus, and notes that the school is a Private Association of Faithful in the Archdiocese of Indianapolis, located in Bloomington, Indiana. This indicates a theology-grounded, liturgical environment.
- The site highlights partnering with parents to foster intellect and faith, signaling a moral/faith formation frame.
- It mentions students learning Latin prayers in Pre-K and includes Mass imagery, signaling liturgical and communal practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (from the Six Elements lexicon): theology, liturgy, Mass, faith, virtue, wisdom, sacred, reverence, holy, sacred music, liturgical life. The site directly artifacts Mass, Latin prayers, and Catholic identity, aligning with liturgical and theological markers.
- Negative keywords are not evident in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The public materials clearly embed theological formation, liturgical life, and Catholic identity, consistent with a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations orientation. The explicit Catholic framing and liturgical elements (Mass, Latin prayers) support a CLASSICAL alignment on these foundations, even though the overall program is not fully developed as a classical school in all six elements.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The motto Sapientia ~ Fides ~ Virtus and the phrase “Partnering with parents to foster intellect and faith” point to a formation-centered purpose that aims at wisdom and virtue in harmony with faith.
- The public materials center on formation and faith integration rather than a job- or skill-first framing. This aligns with the classical aim of formation over mere information, albeit not spelled out with the full classical telos language (true/good/beautiful).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, fidelity/faith, intellect (as part of “intellect and faith”), great conversation or classical heritage language is not explicitly present, but the foundational terms imply classical formation concepts.
- Negative keywords: not present in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school’s stated goal of forming virtue and wisdom within a Catholic framework suggests a classical formation ethos, but the absence of explicit classical telos language (the true, the good, the beautiful) and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references keeps the alignment from reaching full CLASSICAL. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials emphasize Catholic identity and liturgical life and mention Latin prayer practice, but there is no explicit listing of liberal-arts content (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or Great Conversation frameworks in the visible site copy. The clear absence of explicit Great Books, classical canon study, or the trinity of grammar-logic-rhetoric in the materials leads to a gap with the classical curriculum criteria.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators would include mentions of Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin study beyond liturgical prayer, and history treated as a liberal-arts discipline. The site does not clearly present these items.
- Negative indicators: absence of clear Great Books, no explicit history as a liberal-arts discipline, no explicit “great conversation” framing.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit classical curriculum components (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation), the curriculum category does not meet the Six Elements’ criteria for CLASSICAL. The presence of Latin prayers is a positive element but does not fulfill the full curriculum picture. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public content centers on liturgical life and faith formation; there is no explicit documentation of classical pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, narrations, memory work, or the “scholé” approach as the teaching method. The available public materials do not present a Socratic or seminary-based pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators in the classical rubric would include Socratic dialogue, memorization practices, and restful-learning pedagogy (scholé). The site does not show these.
- Negative indicators: absence of those classical methods in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The lack of explicit classical pedagogy means the Pedagogy category does not align with the CLASSICAL standard. The presence of liturgical practices does not substitute for a classical teaching method. NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials do not provide explicit statements about teachers as living curriculum, “faculty of friends,” or classroom mentorship models. The available copy emphasizes Catholic identity and parental partnership rather than descriptions of faculty culture or role models in a classical sense.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords from the Six Elements for Faculty include terms like “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of what a teacher should be,” and “faculty of friends.” These are not clearly evidenced in the public materials at hand.
- No negative indicators are apparent, but the absence of explicit Faculty descriptions precludes a CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating

- Given the absence of explicit “living curriculum” faculty language and explicit mentor-model language, the Faculty category does not meet the CLASSICAL criterion. NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- A clear and explicit statement: “Partnering with parents to foster intellect and faith.” This directly aligns with the Six Elements’ emphasis on parental partnership, formation of parents, and open engagement with families as co-educators. The school’s framing positions parents as collaborators in their children’s faith-formation and intellectual growth.
- The presence of Catholic community affiliation (Archdiocese; Private Association of Faithful) supports a community-centered education model with a faith-based culture and familial involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, parental involvement/co-education, family formation, liturgical/catechetical rhythm implied by Catholic community life.
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials regarding parents and community.
- Why this rating
- The explicit emphasis on partnering with parents and the role of families in formation is a hallmark of CLASSICAL alignment for Parents & Community. While other categories fall short, this is a strong positive indicator for Element 6. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate classification: NOT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The majority of categories (3, 4, and 5) do not meet the classical criteria based on the public materials, while categories 1 and 6 meet classical signals and category 2 shows formation-oriented classical potential. The overall weighting across six categories, with three clear NOT CLASSICAL signals, yields a NOT CLASSICAL aggregate rating.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school sought to shift toward a full CLASSICAL model, concrete steps could include:
- Curriculum: Adopt and publicly publish a classical core curriculum that includes the grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence, Great Books or canonical primary texts, and explicit history as Western civilization framing.
- Pedagogy: Implement explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, memorization via memory work, narration/recitation, and opportunities for formal rhetoric) and communicate these approaches on the site.
- Faculty: Articulate a living-curriculum model for teachers, including professional development in classical pedagogy and a visible “portrait” of teacher ideals aligned with classical formation.
- History and Great Conversation: Integrate Great Books and a “Great Conversation” framing throughout the curriculum, ensuring cross-subject connections and interdisciplinary coherence.
- Community formation: Expand explicit parent formation programs (book studies, lectures) that align with classical-philosophical aims and describe how parents co-educate in partnership with faculty.

- Liturgical and metaphysical integration: Maintain Catholic identity while clearly tying liturgical rhythm to academic formation, with structured opportunities to articulate the transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) in classroom practice.

Note: These needle-moving steps would move the school toward CLASSICAL status on multiple categories (Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and perhaps even Element 2) while preserving and clarifying its strong religious-communal identity (Element 1 and 6).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.